Studio

Diller Scofidio + Renfro (DS+R) is an interdisciplinary design studio that works at the intersection of architecture, the visual arts, and the performing arts. Founded in 1981, the New York-based studio established its identity through independent, conceptual, and self-generated art and architecture installations before reaching international prominence with large cultural and civic projects such as Blur Building at the 2002 Swiss Expo; the Institute of Contemporary Art in Boston; the redevelopment of the Lincoln Center for the Performing Arts in New York; and the High Line in New York. Today, DS+R is led by four partners—Elizabeth Diller, Ricardo Scofidio, Charles Renfro and Benjamin Gilmartin—who work collaboratively with a staff of over 100 architects, designers, artists, and researchers.

Meet Us

ELIZABETH DILLER

Elizabeth Diller founded Diller Scofidio + Renfro in 1981 with partner Ricardo Scofidio. Along with Ric, Liz was awarded the MacArthur Foundation 'Genius' Grant from 1999 to 2004, the first given in the field of architecture. She is a Professor of Architecture at Princeton University. Liz is a Fellow of the American Academy of Arts and Letters, the American Academy of Arts and Sciences, and the Royal Institute of British Architects (RIBA). Among her many honors are a Lifetime Achievement Award from the National Academy of Design, the Brunner Prize from the American Academy of Arts and Letters, the Barnard Medal of Distinction, and an Honorary Doctorate of the Humanities from Occidental College. In 2009, Liz was selected by Time Magazine as one of the "100 Most Influential People in the World."

RICARDO SCOFIDIO

Ricardo Scofidio founded Diller Scofidio + Renfro in 1981 with partner Elizabeth Diller and has over 50 years of experience working in architecture. Along with Diller, Scofidio was awarded the MacArthur Foundation 'Genius' Grant from 1999 to 2004, the first given in the field of architecture. He is Professor Emeritus of Architecture at Cooper Union School of Architecture. Scofidio is a fellow of the American Academy of Arts and Sciences and of the Royal Institute of British Architects. He has been recognized by the National Academy of Design with a Lifetime Achievement Award, and by the American Academy of Arts and Letters with the Brunner Prize. Scofidio was selected by Time Magazine as one of the "100 Most Influential People in the World."

CHARLES RENFRO

Charles Renfro joined the studio in 1997 and was named Partner in 2004; he has practiced architecture for over 30 years. He is a Visiting Professor of Curatorial Studies at the School of Visual Arts in New York. He was recently named a National Academy Academician in 2016, and received the 2015 Texas Medal of the Arts Award. He is President of the Board at Storefront for Art and Architecture in New York, and on the board of Spaceworks, dedicated to providing rehearsal and studio space for New York artists.

BENJAMIN GILMARTIN

Benjamin Gilmartin joined DS+R in 2004 and was named Partner in 2015. Ben has been practicing architecture for over 25 years. Ben is currently a Visiting Instructor and Lecturer for the Harvard Graduate School of Design Thesis Program. Ben lectures extensively, presenting the studio's work to international audiences and has been a longtime contributor to the architecture journal Praxis. In 2015 he delivered the keynote address and served as the Honor Awards Jury Chair for the AIA Colorado and Western Mountain Region Practice and Design Conference, in addition to giving the keynote address for the AIA Wisconsin Convention and Expo. Last year he was also an AIA Minnesota speaker and Honor Awards Jury Member.

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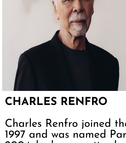

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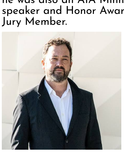

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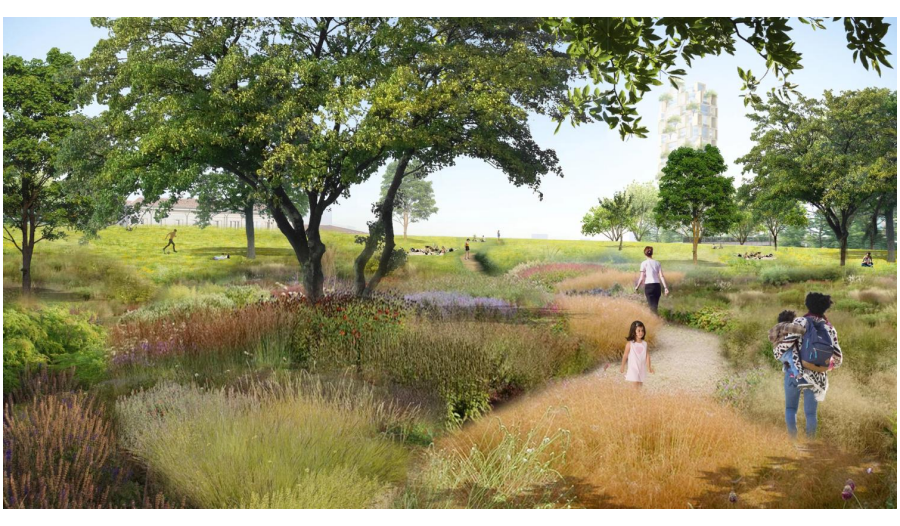

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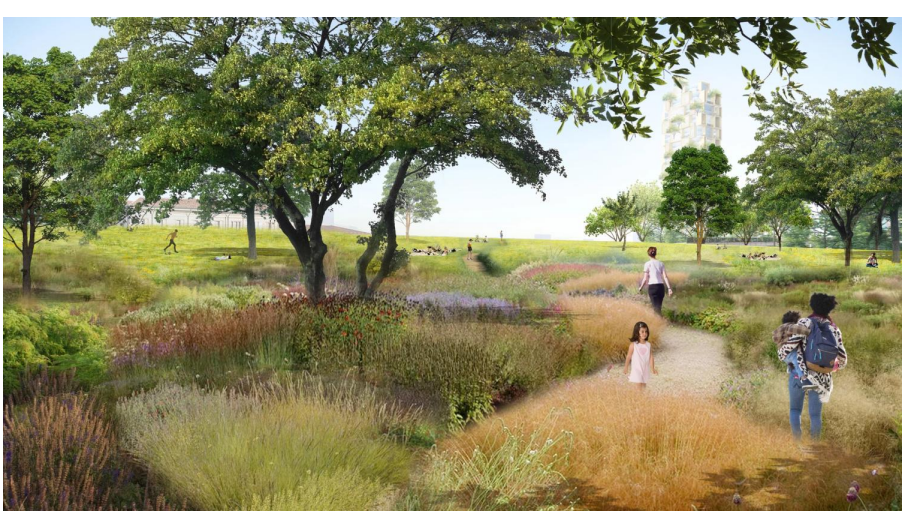

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Adaptive Reuse(5) | Pavilion (4) | Metal (4) | Interdisciplinary (4) | Independent (4) | Hybrid (4)

Competition (4) | Climate (4)

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Canal Café, 2025

Park Union Bridge, 2021

High Line, 2019

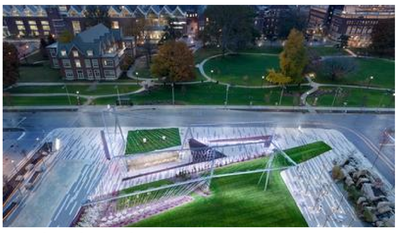
MoMA, 2019

The Tide, 2019

Zaryadye Park, 2017

The Broad, 2015

The Broad Plaza, 2015



Wishard Pavilion, 2014

Lincoln Center for the Performing Arts, 2012

65th Street Bridge, 2012

Lincoln Center Public Spaces, 2010

Arbores Laetae (Joyful Trees), 2008

Blur Building, 2002

All Projects

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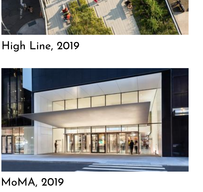

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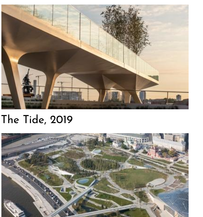

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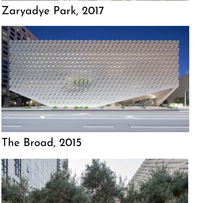

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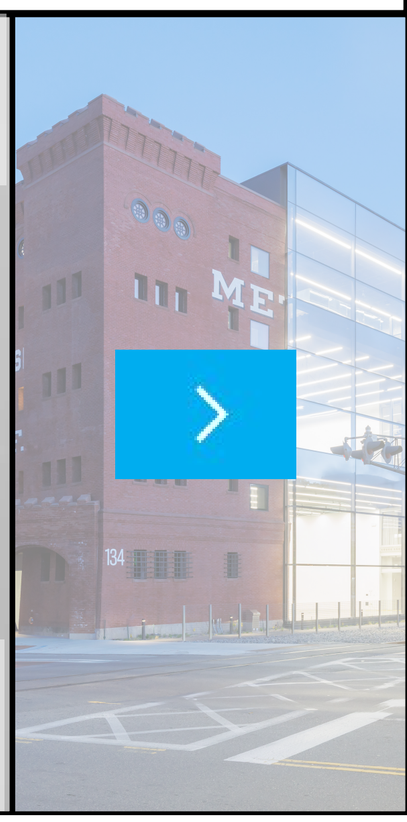

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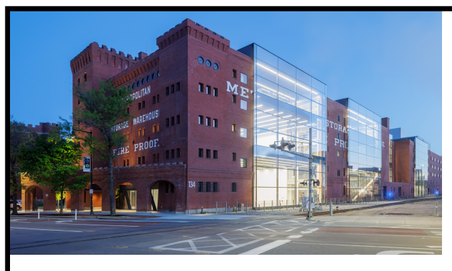

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09/30/2026

A Warehouse is Converted into the New Home of Architecture at MIT

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WSJ
09/29/2026

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-By Ben Kesslen

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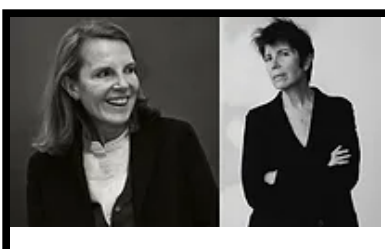

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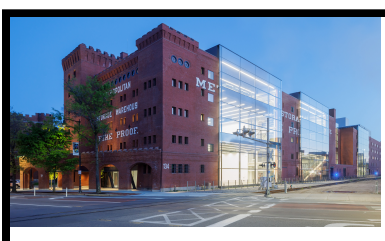

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THE ARCHITECT'S NEWSPAPER
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Upper Montparnasee

(Paris France)

The adaptive reuse of Upper Montparnasse - a heroically scaled 16-story modernist office block situated above the Gare Montparnasse in Paris - will better connect the building to outdoor space and landscape, improve its energy efficiency and natural daylight, and increase public access while celebrating its enormous scale and breathtaking 360-degree views.

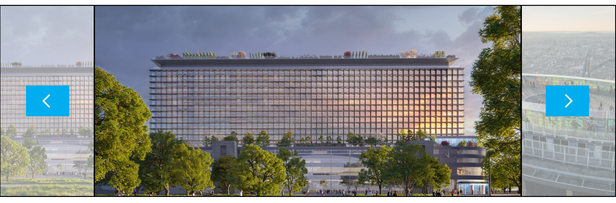
The existing Maine-Montparnasse Transit Hub development, spanning Boulevard du Montparnasse and Boulevard Pasteur, was a new type of urbanism in the 1960s. It was a radially integrated, overlapping cluster of programs, public spaces, and transit infrastructure boldly inserted into Paris' Left Bank as the new modern-city intersection. However, its heroically scaled architecture blocked the historic city from view for arriving train passengers—as if a billboard announcing a hopeful, modernist future. Yet its promise of the connected city has not been realized. Instead of a vitality born from density, commute, and functional mix, much of the site is underused and unloved. The public Jardin Atlantique is out of sight and out of mind, circulation through and around the site is disorienting, and leasable spaces are outdated and undesirable to contemporary tenants.

With half a century of reflection on this site and the opportunity to imagine a new future, its original ambitions still feel as relevant as ever. The sustainable city of the 21st century must embrace mass transit, celebrate public space, promote walkability through density, and link the workplace to the public realm. As the central building within the Maine-Montparnasse development, renovating the existing CNP Assurances building will catalyze this vision and the ambitions of the master plan and surrounding new developments, bringing transit, public space, and workspace into a new equilibrium.

Both iconic and unnoticed, the existing building's heroically-scaled architecture is a modernist paradox that must undergo radical surgery to become relevant again. As business models change and the future of work remains uncertain, the most enduring investments in the building will be those that enhance its natural assets.

The renovation proposal focuses on improving proximity and connectivity to outdoor spaces and landscape, upgrading the building's energy efficiency and lighting, and celebrating its enormous scale and breathtaking 360-degree views. The existing low-ceiling, single-story reception zone expands into a three-story super lobby and connects to a new train station rooftop landscape, giving tenants an expansive indoor-outdoor amenity zone. A rooftop urban farm crowns the tower, a new icon for Paris. Three sets of condensed cores replace a single mega-core, providing more flexible, open workspaces, with through-spaces bathed in natural light from both sides of the tower. Double-height spaces and outdoor terraces provide opportunities for interconnected floors, a range of scales for flexible uses, and a celebration of remarkable views of Paris.

A new sawtooth glass façade takes advantage of the building's length and underlying gridded abstraction to produce a subtly changing fragmented reflection as one moves around it and over the course of the day. The opaque vertical return of the sawtooth façade strategically reduces low-angle morning and evening sunlight and houses operable windows that promote natural ventilation. Cantilevered horizontal sunshades at each floor further reduce solar heat gain and energy consumption throughout the day. With contemporary glass performance and façade design that allows more light and transparency than was possible in the 1960s, the building becomes more modern than the modernism it promised.



Project Information

Client - Altarea SCA
Caisse des Depot

Size (GSF) - 613543

Location - Paris, France

Competition - 2020

Opening 2027

Credits

Partners - Charles Renfro, Elizabeth Diller, Benjamin Gilmartin, and Ricardo Scofidio

Project Leaders - Charles Berman and Ellix Wu

Sustainability & Ecology Director - Sean Gallagher

Designers - Jeremy Boon-Bordenave, Sean Rowe, Alfred Wei, Jay Manley, Dino Kiratzidis, Giannantonio Bongiorno, Mackinley Wang-Xu, Michael Robitz, Eranga De Zoysa, Andrés Macera, Adin Rimland, Will Le, Rawan Elnatour Magdalena Naydekova, Aubrey Lynch, Jay Manley, Diego Soto Madrinan, and Radu Remus Macovei

External Credits

Executive Architect - SRA ARCHITECTES

Landscape Architect - ATELIER TISSOT

Project Manager/BIM Manager - ARTELIA

Structural Engineer - TERREL

MEP Engineer - EGIS

Facade/Environment Consultant - ELIOTH

Acoustical Consultant - AVEL ACOUSTIQUE

Vertical Transportation Consultant - MOVVÉO

Food Service Consultant - INFLUENCE RESTAURATION

Cost Consultant - AE 75

Building Technical Control Consultant - SOCOTEC

Fire Safety Consultant - CSD & ASSOCIES

Fire Security System Coordinator BATISS

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United Kingdom
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London EC4N 6EL, UK

The Brasserie

(New York, New York)

The original Brasserie was designed by Philip Johnson and opened two years after the completion of the Seagram Building, in 1958. A legendary late-night spot for the Studio 54 crowd, the restaurant remained a popular round-the-clock eatery until it was destroyed by a kitchen fire in 1995. After it sat vacant for four years, the restaurant operator hired an architect to redesign the restaurant in a kitschy historical style. The construction plans had to be approved by Phyllis Lambert, who had originally selected Mies van der Rohe to design the building and continued to serve as its guardian and aesthetic conscience, protecting it from the vagaries of time and bad commercial impulses. Lambert immediately rejected the restaurant plans, tossing years of work into the waste bin. Intervening in the building's history once again, she selected her preferred architect.

The design of the new Brasserie was prompted by the irony of its location. Lodged in the stone base of New York's quintessential Modernist glass tower, the restaurant was entirely opaque, without a single pane of glass. The new design, by contrast, is a study of glass, transparency, and vision itself. A live video camera outside the entry feeds a plasma monitor inside and creates a virtual transparency between the street and foyer. This surrogate electronic window straddles the stone wall of the building's base. The ritual of making an entrance begins at the rev[illegible]ront door. A sensor above it automatically triggers the capture of a video portra[illegible]h arriving patron; their surveillance-like image is added to a continuously cha[illegible]deo display over the bar. Entry into the main dining room, one-half level below the street, is effectively a runway walk: after patrons are announced on-screen, they appear in the flesh, descending down a long glass stairway and landing in the center of the dining room, where they are escorted to a table. The restaurant also offers other opportunities to consider the many attributes of glass, including its fragility, its optical properties, and its invitation to voyeurism.

Project Information

Location - New York, United States **Size (GSF)** - 7000

Credits

Partners - Elizabeth Diller and Ricardo Scofidio

Project Leaders - Charles Renfro

Sustainability & Ecology Director - Sean Gallagher

Designers - Deane Simpson, Lyn Rice, Matthew Johnson, and Nicholas de Monechaux

External Credits

EAR STUDIO

STRUCTURED ENVIRONMENT

Lighting Design - RICHARD SHAVER

Curtain Design - MARY BRIGHT

2X4

Z CORPORATION

CONSTRUCTION BY DESIGN

The Brasserie

(Paris France)

The original Brasserie was designed by Philip Johnson and opened two years after the completion of the Seagram Building, in 1958. A legendary late-night spot for the Studio 54 crowd, the restaurant remained a popular round-the-clock eatery until it was destroyed by a kitchen fire in 1995. After it sat vacant for four years, the restaurant operator hired an architect to redesign the restaurant in a kitschy historical style. The construction plans had to be approved by Phyllis Lambert, who had originally selected Mies van der Rohe to design the building and continued to serve as its guardian and aesthetic conscience, protecting it from the vagaries of time and bad commercial impulses. Lambert immediately rejected the restaurant plans, tossing years of work into the waste bin. Intervening in the building's history once again, she selected her preferred architect.

The design of the new Brasserie was prompted by the irony of its location. Lodged in the stone base of New York's quintessential Modernist glass tower, the restaurant was entirely opaque, without a single pane of glass. The new design, by contrast, is a study of glass, transparency, and vision itself. A live video camera outside the entry feeds a plasma monitor inside and creates a virtual transparency between the street and foyer. This surrogate electronic window straddles the stone wall of the building's base. The ritual of making an entrance begins at the revolving front door. A sensor above it automatically triggers the capture of a video portrait of each arriving patron; their surveillance-like image is added to a continuously changing video display over the bar. Entry into the main dining room, one-half level below the street, is effectively a runway walk: after patrons are announced on-screen, they appear in the flesh, descending down a long glass stairway and landing in the center of the dining room, where they are escorted to a table. The restaurant also offers other opportunities to consider the many attributes of glass, including its fragility, its optical properties, and its invitation to voyeurism.

Project Information

Location - New York, United States

Size (GSF) - 7000

Credits

Partners - Elizabeth Diller and Ricardo Scofidio

Project Leaders - Charles Renfro

Sustainability & Ecology Director - Sean Gallagher

Designers - Deane Simpson, Lyn Rice, Matthew Johnson, and Nicholas de Monechaux

External Credits

Executive Architect - SRA ARCHITECTES

Landscape Architect - ATELIER TISSOT

Project Manager/BIM Manager - ARTELIA

Structural Engineer - TERREL

MEP Engineer - EGIS

Facade/Environment Consultant - ELIOTH

Acoustical Consultant - AVEL ACOUSTIQUE

Vertical Transportation Consultant - MOVVÉO

Food Service Consultant - INFLUENCE RESTAURATION

Cost Consultant - AE 75

Building Technical Control Consultant - SOCOTEC

Fire Safety Consultant - CSD & ASSOCIES

Fire Security System Coordinator - BATISS